

Rusted Door



Untested assumptions

Rusted Door

Structure - Architecture of Assumption



Untested assumptions



Assumptions allow starting somewhere by replacing reality by simple foundations. However, assumptions need to be tested so that they don't become unvalidated dogma and lock the model into error.



prior hypotheses, foundational beliefs, hidden consequences, simplifications, model closed world



Assumptions collapse uncertainty and make progress possible.



An untested assumption goes unnoticed.



Check premise of target card against held-out data.



"Which model assumption have you never actually tested, and what would testing it look like?"



The scholar walked past the door daily noting its state of decay. When he pressed his palm to the rusted frame, the hinges screamed and the door shut forever.

